

Not Finished, But Abandoned

by

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ACKNOWLEDGMENTS

It is customary for authors of academic books to include in their prefaces statements such as this: "I am indebted to ... for their invaluable help; however, any errors which remain are my sole responsibility." Occasionally an author will go further. Rather than say that if there are any mistakes then he is responsible for them, he will say that there will inevitably be some mistakes and he is responsible for them....

Although the shouldering of all responsibility is usually a social ritual, the admission that errors exist is not — it is often a sincere avowal of belief. But this appears to present a living and everyday example of a situation which philosophers have commonly dismissed as absurd; that it is sometimes rational to hold logically incompatible beliefs.

— DAVID C. MAKINSON (1965)

Above is the famous "preface paradox," which illustrates how to use the `wbepi` environment for epigraphs at the beginning of chapters. You probably also want to thank the Academy.

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ABSTRACT

FIXME: basically a placeholder; do not believe

I did some research, read a bunch of papers, published a couple myself, (pick one):

1. ran some experiments and made some graphs,
2. proved some theorems

and now I have a job. I've assembled this document in the last couple of months so you will let me leave. Thanks!

1 INTRODUCTION

1.1 What the heck is a plasma

1.1.1 Plasmas in the universe

1.1.2 How do plasmas affect us on earth?

1.1.3 Where does magnetic reconnection play into this whole shabang?

1.2 Magnetic Reconnection

1.2.1 The Generalized Ohm's Law

1.2.1.1 How do we derive this?

1.2.1.2 A breakdown of the terms

1.2.2 Regimes of Reconnection

1.2.2.1 Reconnection scaling parameters

i.e. why do we use S and L/d_i to characterize reconnection regimes?

Figure 1.1: Cartoon of places where reconnection can happen.

Figure 1.2: Diagram of reconnection regimes.

Figure 1.3: Diagram of Sweet-Parker reconnection.

1.2.2.2 Where do various systems line up?

1.2.2.3 What are we interested in?

1.2.3 Sweet-Parker Reconnection

1.2.3.1 A quick historical detour

1.2.3.2 What are the assumptions that go into Sweet-Parker?

1.2.3.3 Sweet-Parker Reconnection Rate Derivation

1.2.3.4 Application to Real Systems

1.2.3.4.1 What are some example parameters where reconnection occurs?

1.2.3.4.2 What time scales does Sweet-Parker predict?

1.2.3.4.3 What did we miss?

1.2.4 Hall Reconnection

1.2.4.1 Why should the Hall term appear?

1.2.4.1.1 What is the relevant physics that sets when the hall term matters

1.2.4.1.2 In what kind of plasmas does the hall term appear and when does it not?

Figure 1.4: Diagram of 2d hall reconnection

Figure 1.5: Flux tube changing size during reconnection causing pressure anisotropy build up.

1.2.4.2 What does hall reconnection look like

1.2.4.3 What's missing?

1.2.5 Kinetic Reconnection

1.2.5.1 What makes kinetic reconnection “kinetic”?

1.2.5.1.1 What do collisions do?

1.2.5.1.1.1 How quickly do collisions damp out non-Maxwellian features?

1.2.5.1.2 What makes a system kinetic?

1.2.5.1.2.1 What parameters set this?

1.2.5.1.2.2 What should we do in the lab to get this?

1.2.5.2 Where does Pressure Anisotropy come from?

1.2.5.2.1 Movement of flux tube

1.2.5.2.2 Effect of background field

1.2.5.2.2.1 Too low of background field does...

1.2.5.2.2.2 Too high of field does...

Figure 1.6: Simulated kinetic reconnection with changing guide field.

Figure 1.7: Diagram from Ohia of with and without pressure anisotropy in simulation.

Figure 1.8: Some figure from Jan's papers showing effects of pressure anisotropy

1.2.5.2.2.3 Goldilocks!

1.2.5.3 How does pressure anisotropy change what the reconnection looks like

1.2.5.3.1 Thinner reconnection layer? Use results from Jan's more recent papers.

1.2.5.3.2 Marginal Firehose Condition

1.2.5.3.3 Concluding: what features should we look for in the data?

1.2.5.4 Why do we want to measure it?

At the end of experimental setup I'll talk about why we want to do it in the lab but I think motivating why we care about kinetic reconnection as a process would be good here.

1.2.5.4.1 Simulation result overview

1.2.5.4.2 Spacecraft result overview

1.2.5.4.3 Experimental result?

1.3 Experimental Setup

1.3.1 Overall how does our experiment progress

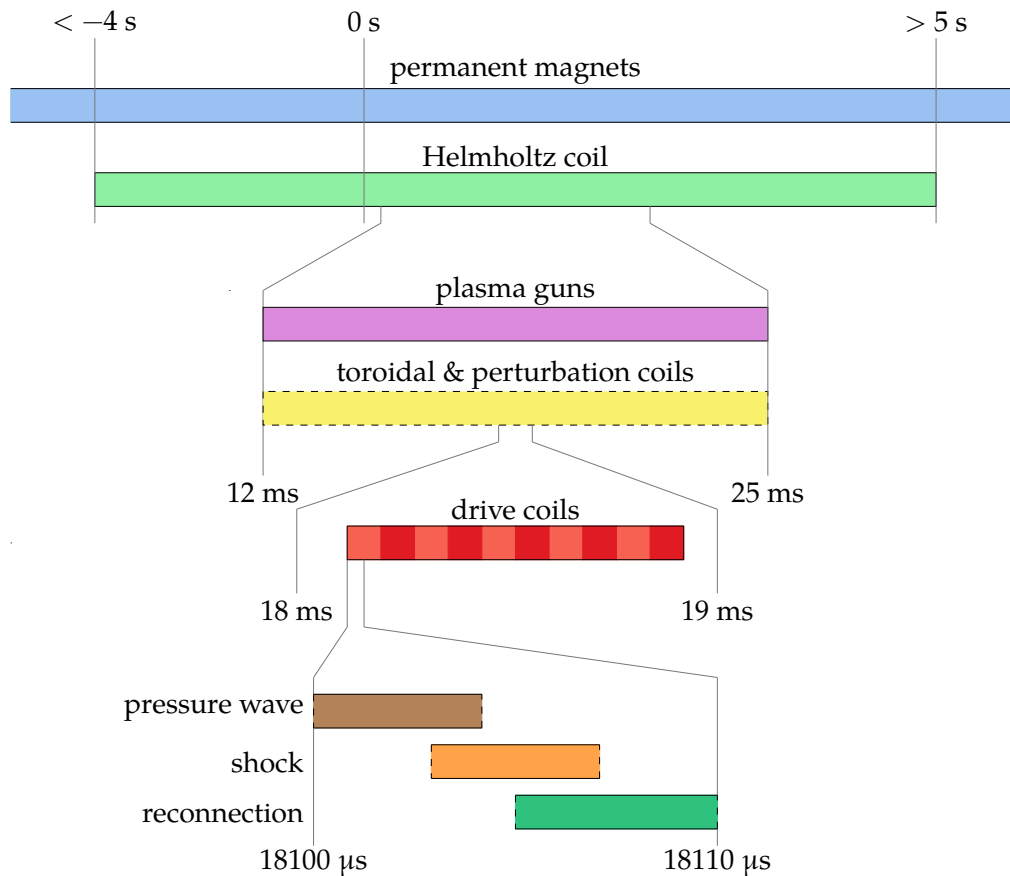


Figure 1.9: Timeline of experimental sequence.

Figure 1.10: Panels from flux arrays of experiment happening.

Figure 1.11: Circuit diagram of plasma gun.

Figure 1.12: Simplified cut of plasma gun insides.

1.3.2 Initial field

1.3.2.1 Helmholtz

1.3.2.2 Permanent magnets

1.3.2.3 Toroidal

1.3.2.3.1 Shifted coil

1.3.2.3.2 Axial coil

1.3.2.4 Perturbation coils

1.3.3 Plasma Generation

1.3.3.1 How do our guns work

1.3.3.1.1 Gas lines

1.3.3.1.2 PFNs

1.3.3.1.3 Puff trigger

1.3.3.1.4 How to breakdown

1.3.3.2 How are the guns placed for injection?

1.3.3.2.1 How much do they fill the machine

1.3.3.2.2 What sets the filling fraction

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Table 1.1: List of diagnostics used in the experiment and what they can measure.

1.3.3.3 What goes wrong with them

1.3.3.3.1 Burning up

1.3.3.3.2 Burn holes in wall because of background field Get image from Paul with hole in wall.

1.3.3.3.3 Air cooling

1.3.3.3.4 Optimizing gun operation

1.3.4 Drive field

1.3.4.1 Individual coils

1.3.4.1.1 Zone's between coils as plasma sources

1.3.4.2 Drive Cylinder

Reference Paul's RSI + thesis.

1.3.5 Diagnostics Overview

1.3.5.1 Bdot probes

1.3.5.1.1 Basic principles

1.3.5.1.2 Probe types

1.3.5.1.2.1 Linear probe

1.3.5.1.2.2 Hook probe

1.3.5.1.2.3 Speed probe

1.3.5.1.2.4 Flux array 1

1.3.5.1.2.5 Flux array 2

1.3.5.1.3 Data Interpretation How do we convert the raw data into something useful?

1.3.5.2 Hall probes

1.3.5.2.1 Basic principles

1.3.5.2.2 Issues and feasibility

1.3.5.3 Langmuir probes

1.3.5.3.1 Basic principles

1.3.5.3.2 What do we need to do to make them work for our device?

1.3.5.3.3 Look into XXX chapter

1.3.5.4 Fast camera

1.3.5.4.1 What can we see with it?

1.3.5.4.2 Potential use cases

Table 1.2: Comparison of lab and space parameters.

1.3.6 How does the experiment compare to space

1.3.6.1 Simulation benefits and results

1.3.6.2 Space benefits and results

1.3.6.3 Lab benefits and results

1.3.7 Other lab reconnection experiments

1.3.7.1 VTF, MRX, FLARE

1.3.7.2 Exploding wire arrays

1.3.7.3 Laser based

2 PRESSURE WAVE

2.1 Introduction

Once I get Jan's rewrite of the intro + conclusion I can figure out what might go here.

Figure 2.1: dBz/dt plots for different Helmholtz fields

Figure 2.2: Greess et al. 2022 paper showing simulations with pressure wave.

2.2 Observations that lead us to look at this wave

2.2.1 Speed probe measurements

2.2.1.1 Flux expansion before shock layer

2.2.1.2 Wavefront that depends on configuration

2.2.2 Simulations

2.2.2.1 Different n and drive change feature

2.2.2.2 Change reconnection layer post reflection

2.3 Physical understanding of wave

2.3.1 Initial plasma configuration

2.3.2 Release in magnetic pressure

2.3.2.1 What would happen if plasma was immobile (replaced with perfect conductor)

All field is shielded at edge and there is no change in magnetic pressure in the bulk.

2.3.3 Wavefront tells plasma about pressure Release

2.3.3.1 Analogous system

Sound wave.

How does a sound wave propagate in a plasma? Fast magnetosonic wave!

Figure 2.3: Simple diagram of sound wave in container

2.3.4 Modeling magnetic field response

2.3.4.1 How do we create this model

2.3.4.2 Pressure wave is like a shield

2.3.4.3 Example

2.3.4.4 Why have we mentioned this?

2.3.4.4.1 Important for probe calibrations

2.3.4.4.2 Good for predicting effects of different coil configurations

2.4 Wave Simulation

2.4.1 Approximations

2.4.2 Linearizing MHD

2.4.3 Plasma Equilibrium + Symmetries

2.4.3.1 Types of Equilibrium

2.4.3.1.1 theta-pinch

2.4.3.1.2 screw-pinch

2.4.3.2 Types of Symmetries

2.4.3.2.1 z-symmetry

2.4.3.2.2 toroidal-symmetry

Table 2.1: Parameters for normalization

2.4.4 Simplified 1D equation

2.4.4.1 What does this look like?

A wave equation!

2.4.4.2 Normalizations

2.4.4.3 Normalized equation

2.4.5 Boundary conditions

2.4.5.1 $r = 0$ Boundary

2.4.5.1.1 $v = 0$ option

2.4.5.1.2 $\xi = 0$ option

2.4.5.1.3 What do we choose?

2.4.5.2 $r = R$ Boundary

2.4.5.2.1 What is physically happening at high radius in the coils?

2.4.5.2.2 Loop voltage sets dB_z/dt

2.4.5.2.3 Assuming MHD so far so let's keep assuming!

2.4.5.2.4 Vloop signal shape

2.4.6 Initial conditions

2.4.6.1 What form can we expect plasma to take?

2.4.6.2 What form do we use for these results

2.4.7 What does our simulation show?

2.4.7.1 There is a wavefront traveling inwards at fast magnetosonic

2.4.7.1.1 Low beta approximation giving Alfven

2.4.7.2 Once wavefront passes, plasma moves out

2.4.7.3 Converting to B_{dot}

2.4.7.4 In B_{dot} we see flux moving outwards

As expected from MHD assumption.

2.5 How do we apply it to real data?

2.5.1 Base requirements

2.5.1.1 Cylindrical symmetry

2.5.1.2 Releasing magnetic pressure at high radius

2.5.1.3 Measurements along a radial chord

2.5.1.4 Known initial field

2.5.2 Extracting the wave speed from the data

2.5.2.1 Wave tracking

2.5.2.1.1 Edge finding

Figure 2.4: Data vs. crude minimum density vs. empirical minimum density

Figure 2.5: Diagram of what the more complex model looks like.

2.5.2.1.2 Inertia

2.5.2.1.3 Monte-carlo

2.5.2.1.4 Centered finite difference

2.5.2.1.5 Mean + Standard Deviation of Speed

2.5.3 Getting the density

2.5.3.1 Using the alfven speed

2.5.4 Minimum measurable density

2.5.4.1 Assuming sample resolution

2.5.4.1.1 What does this assumption derive

2.5.4.1.2 How does it compare to the data

2.5.4.1.3 We need a better approximation

Figure 2.6: CAD rendering of BRB w/ drive cylinder, flux probes, and Te probe.

Figure 2.7: Plot of langmuir density and wave density

Figure 2.8: Diagram of sheath overlap for multitiplangmuir probe

2.5.4.2 Assuming sub-sample resolution

**2.5.4.3 A more complex model assuming the plasma is a step function
* linear**

2.6 Does it reproduce langmuir probe results

2.6.1 Experimental setup

2.6.1.1 Drive cylinder

2.6.1.2 Te probe along equator

2.6.2 Results

2.6.2.1 Langmuir probe minimum measurable density

2.6.2.2 Impacts of simple Langmuir model vs BRL

Refer to figure in Te section showing how it matters.

2.6.2.3 What happens to the wave shape in simulation vs. experiment

2.6.2.3.1 Two-fluid dispersion

2.6.2.3.2 How might we expect this to change the wave

Figure 2.9: Plot of two-fluid dispersion relation

Figure 2.10: Results of simulating application of dispersion relation to pressure wave

Figure 2.11: Initial density before and after many shots

Figure 2.12: Initial density for varying gun number

2.6.2.3.3 How to simulate evolution approximately

2.6.2.3.4 Dispersion simulation results

2.7 Applications

2.7.1 Other machines where this is applicable

LAPD & MRX

Figure 2.13: Initial density for varying Helmholtz

Figure 2.14: Diagram of flux mechanisms.

Figure 2.15: Example diffusion simulation

Figure 2.16: Example of cross-correlation

2.7.2 Diagnosing gun failures

2.7.3 Measuring effect of different gun number and Helmholtz strength

2.7.3.1 Gun number

2.7.3.2 Helmholtz

2.7.4 Measuring diffusion coefficient

2.7.4.1 Diffusion theoretical model

2.7.4.2 Diffusion simulations

2.7.4.3 Applications of pressure wave model

I think I need to do a bit more research here to show that we can actually extract a diffusion coefficient.

Figure 2.17: Example of DTW

2.8 Future Research

2.8.1 Better wave tracking

2.8.1.1 Cross-correlation

2.8.1.2 Dynamic Time Warping

2.8.1.3 Using a model of what the wave looks like

2.8.2 Using fast-magnetosonic speed instead of alfven

2.8.2.1 Will this iteratively converge?

3 MULTI-TIP LANGMUIR PROBE

3.1 What's a Langmuir probe

Hershkowitz: Hershkowitz (1989) Hutchinson: Hutchinson (2002) Olson: Olson (2020)

Plasma diagnostics make a broad phylogenetic tree ranging from the variety of plasma parameters they can measure to their size and complexity. In the Big Red Ball we prefer simplicity and cheapness to some of the wilder diagnostic varieties so a common probe that we use is a Langmuir probe.

3.1.1 Basic Construction

These Langmuir probes are quite basic in construction. At it's simplest, a conductor is placed in contact with the plasma and a voltage is applied relative to ground which we will call the probe voltage, V_{probe} . This will locally perturb the plasma and collect a current, I_{probe} , which can be seen in figure 3.1. If $V_{\text{probe}} < V_{\text{plasma}}$, an electric field is formed that repels electrons and attracts ions and the inverse for $V_{\text{probe}} > V_{\text{plasma}}$.

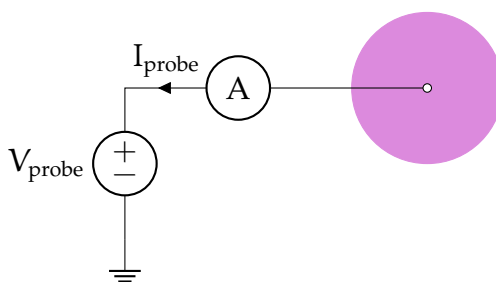


Figure 3.1: A circuit for a very simple Langmuir probe. The probe is biased to the probe voltage, V_{probe} , relative to ground by the power supply. The conductor (white circle) collects ions and electrons from the plasma (pink circle) causing a current to the probe, I_{probe} .

Langmuir probes have been developed to work in a very wide range of plasma parameter configurations that well encompass the plasma parameters TREX achieves (see table 1.2).

3.1.2 Extracting Plasma Parameters

The most challenging part of these probes is the conversion of measured current to plasma parameters. Since we are trying to get a local measurement of the plasma parameters and we are also perturbing the plasma locally by touching it with a probe, we need to create a theory that correctly takes into account that perturbation such that we can get the plasma parameters. This often consists of a fitting procedure where the difference between the theoretical and experimental I-V curves is minimized.

Additionally, many a probe theory is purpose built for plasmas with no magnetic field. As we are studying magnetic reconnection in which there are in fact magnetic fields, this could change the I-V characteristic in unexpected ways. We'll discuss below why these effects are not very impactful and in future sections describe the theories we use for extracting the plasma parameters.

3.1.3 Plasma Perturbation

A problem often found in highly magnetized plasma devices is the long range perturbation to the plasma by the probe. In the Big Red Ball there are times where we have a relatively strong field and times when we don't so let's examine both cases.

3.1.3.1 Unmagnetized Perturbation

Let's examine this from an unmagnetized starting point. In this configuration, the probe collects nearly isotropically to an extent limited by the Debye length which creates a sheath around the probe and operates to

shield the electric field caused by the difference between V_{probe} and V_{plasma} . This length scale is very short and plasma can easily refill the sheath in this unmagnetized system.

3.1.3.2 Magnetic Field Effects

Now in a highly magnetized system (gyroradius far smaller than probe length scale) the plasma interacting with the probe comes from a flux tube approximately the size of the probe area projected into the magnetic field direction. Because of this, the probe can start “emptying out” the flux tube because of the difficulty of plasma to diffuse across field lines into the flux tube. This means the extend of the probe perturbation is far longer.

3.1.3.3 Perturbations in our System

We are quite lucky in that our system geometry reduces the impacts of flux tube emptying and the plasmas we are studying are often relatively unmagnetized.

3.1.3.3.1 Geometric Considerations The TREX experiment is (often) cylindrically symmetric and our probes are placed in different toroidal planes (see figure 2.6 for coordinate system reference). This means that without any toroidal field, any emptying only occurs in the plane of the probe which may still affect the probe I-V characteristic but is not affecting other probes measurements in a significant manner. When we do have a toroidal field, we also often have non-uniform B_r and B_z which means the flux tube passes through many different plasma parameters. This may help to average out any flux tube emptying because at different points along the flux tube more plasma may be able to enter the tube than just what is expected at the probe causing a reduced perturbation length.

Table 3.1: Langmuir probe characteristic scales.

3.1.3.3.2 Magnetic Field Considerations As we have magnetic fields in our system, we do need to worry about these flux tube effects. Fortunately, our magnetic field are relatively small and in the region we are often most interested in (where reconnection is occurring) the magnetic field is far smaller than the initial background field. We characterize this smallness by the ratio of the gyroradius to the radius of the probe area which is on the order of ???.

3.2 Hardware

There has been a long and storied history of probe building on the Big Red Ball especially for the development of multi-tip Langmuir probes. For some more information about our probes, see Olson (2020).

3.2.1 Physical Constraints

Our Langmuir probes need to satisfy a number of requirements.

- **Length:** The probe is attached to a port on the surface of the machine. This means it starts at a spherical radius of 1.5 m and must be inserted from there. Thus the insertable length should be fairly long and must be stable. This is described in 3.2.2.
- **Material:** We want our probe to survive the plasma exposure and not affect our vacuum pressure via offgassing. We also don't want to have to worry about secondary electron emission. We discuss this in 3.2.3.

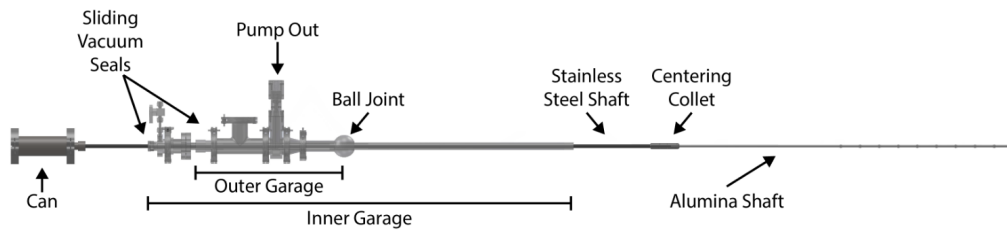


Figure 3.2: Three stage probe shaft with an outer and inner garage and the main stainless steel shaft that connects to the probe.

- Probe Size:** We want to measure the plasma locally so our probe body needs to be small relative to the plasma gradients. It also needs to be able to fit through ball joints that can be mounted to the machine that have a radius of ???. These considerations are taken into account in 3.2.3.

3.2.2 Shaft Components

For our probe to reach everywhere we want and also actually be in the position we desire we need a long shaft with a sufficient amount of support to be accurate to a few centimeters. Why a few centimeters? Our plasma dynamics are reproducible but not to such an extreme that a centimeter is noticeably different. Also it's difficult with the probe length to achieve too much better.

3.2.2.1 Garages

As can be seen in figure 3.2, the probe shaft is a multistage system. Each stage consists of some tubing where connections between different stages are made using quick-connect high-vacuum fittings (like part 3486N32 from McMaster-Carr).

We mount the probe to the machine using a flange on the outer garage or a ball joint (as seen in the figure). Then we can move each garage

independently to insert the probe a desired length.

3.2.2.2 Shaft materials

We need to sufficiently support our probe and the shafts themselves so we use stainless steel until we enter the plasma region in which we change to alumina.

For the shafts, stainless steel is vacuum safe, tolerant to plasma interaction, and can support the weight of the structure easily without excessive flexing. Unfortunately, as a conductor, it will act as a long Langmuir probe that will create a ray in the machine at a single potential. This will perturb the plasma much more significantly than using an insulator.

To that end we use alumina, a high temperature ceramic whose surface will accumulate charge such that it'll be left at the floating potential (the potential at which the ion and electron currents balance). This helps to perturb the plasma less as there is no net current to the shaft and thus the plasma should (hopefully) be less perturbed.

Right near the end of the probe shaft, we use stainless steel tubing to connect from the alumina to the probe body. This is to reduce the overall size of the shaft in perturbing the plasma at the probe and is only for 10 cm of length.

3.2.2.3 Centering Collet

Each shaft/garage, is held in place by the sliding vacuum seal that connects it to its larger garage. Unfortunately this gives only a single point of contact for making the shafts concentric. This would cause excessive drooping of the probe and may be so bad as to cause the probe to hit the edge of the machine when being inserted/removed.

To fix this issue, we have used centering collets that allow the inner shaft/garage to move while being held in place by the outer garage. These

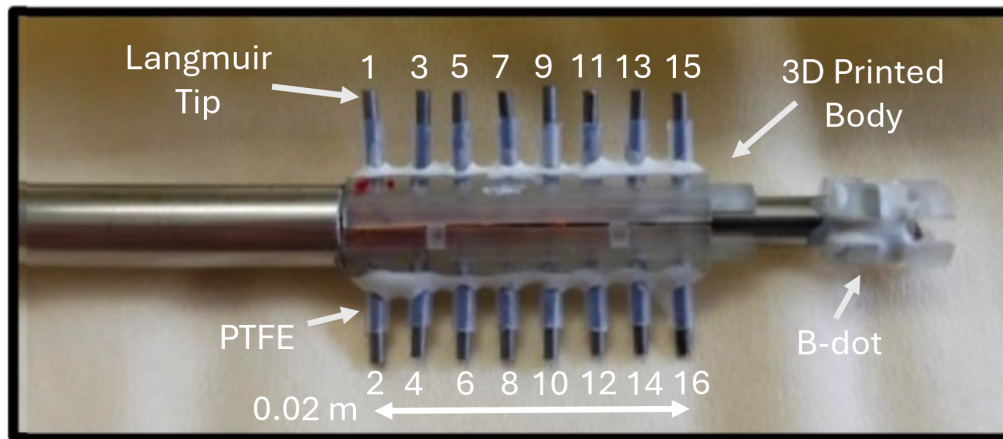


Figure 3.3: Picture of the end of the multi-tip Langmuir probe. Image from Gradney (2025).

can be both machined or 3D printed. When 3D printed we can make these to also hold the o-rings so they are double-acting.

3.2.2.4 Feed-thru

We need some way to extract the signals from the probe tip. Because of the construction of our probe and for simplicity purposes, the probe shaft is at vacuum pressure. Thus we attach a feed-thru to the end of the can from figure 3.2. This is constructed using two DB-25 hermetically sealed connectors where we solder the wires directly to the vacuum side of the can and then can easily move and connect the probe externally.

3.2.3 Tip Components

3.2.3.1 Probe body

Our probe does not need to withstand extreme heat fluxes and our vacuum conditions don't need to be perfect so we are lucky enough to be able to use a 3D printed probe body.

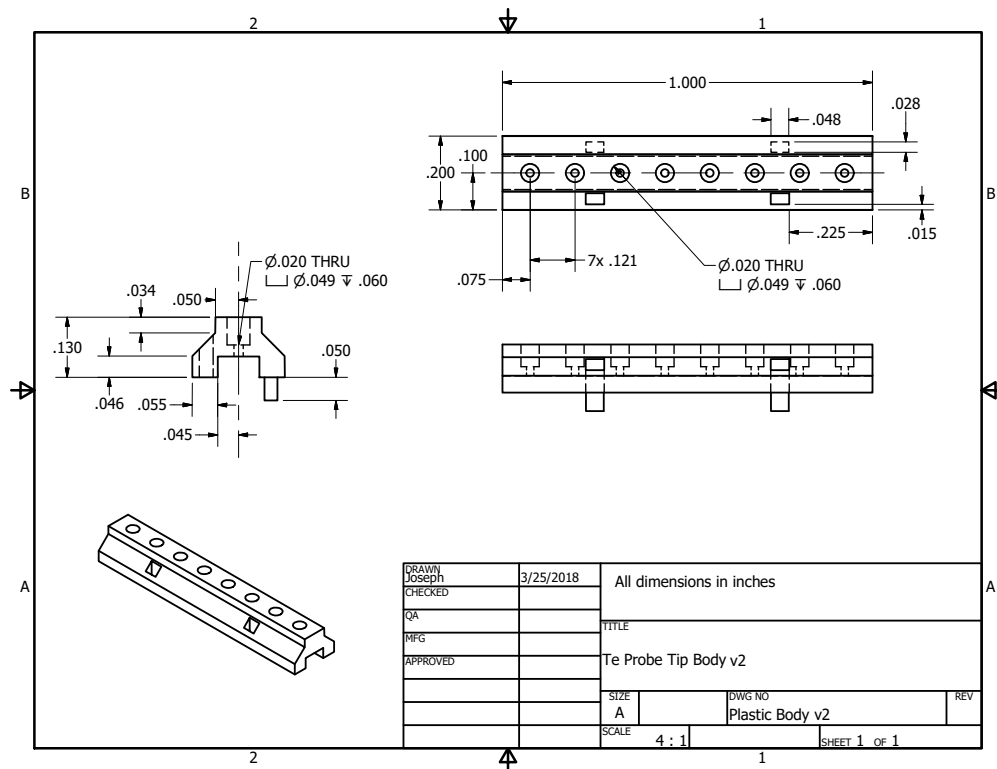


Figure 3.4: Probe body from engineering sketch. Created by Joe Olson.

This is constructed using stereolithography which gives a sufficient resolution for the probe. Additionally the plastic used holds up well in vacuum. The body must connect to two different diameter stainless steel tubes (as can be seen in figure 3.3). Thus we use two annuli whose inner/outer radii match the tubing.

The tubing exists to connect the probe to the main shaft holding it up and also a small B-dot coil which is discussed in 3.2.4.

3.2.3.2 Tip material + size

3.2.3.2.1 Why use Mo

Table 3.2: Length scales of probe

Figure 3.5: Circuit diagram of old setup. Add switches.

Figure 3.6: Image of old setup

3.2.3.2.2 Why use the size we chose

3.2.3.3 Tip Shielding

3.2.3.3.1 Why shield at all?

3.2.3.3.2 First order mach effects to avoid

3.2.4 B-dot Coils

3.2.4.1 How many wraps

3.2.4.2 Approximate area

3.2.5 Length Scales

3.3 Circuitry

3.3.1 Bias Source

3.3.1.1 Manually Controlled

3.3.1.1.1 Principles of operation - Equation to use for bias calculation

3.3.1.1.2 Problems - Had to be manually controlled for drastic bias changes - Wires often contacted each other or parts would lose contact

Figure 3.7: Circuit diagram of new setup. Add switches.

Figure 3.8: Image of new setup

Table 3.3: Bias circuit component values

3.3.1.2 Remote Controlled

3.3.1.2.1 Principles of operation - Equation to use for calculation

3.3.1.2.2 Problems - Destroyed a power supply - A resistor was designed and thus burnt out

3.3.1.2.3 Calibration

3.3.2 Probe Circuit

3.3.2.1 Principles of operation

3.3.2.1.1 Plasma draws current

3.3.2.1.2 Voltage drop across sense resistor

3.3.2.1.3 Measure high frequency voltage drop

3.3.2.2 Single-ended measurement

3.3.2.3 Differential measurement

3.3.2.4 Circuit Solution

3.3.2.4.1 How do we solve this

Figure 3.9: Simple circuit diagram

Figure 3.10: Image of old circuit board

Figure 3.11: Image of new circuit board

Table 3.4: Probe circuit component values

3.3.2.4.1.1 Kirkoff's laws

3.3.2.4.1.2 System of equations

3.3.2.4.1.3 SymPy

3.3.2.4.2 equations

3.3.2.4.3 Assumptions

3.3.2.5 Calibration

3.3.2.5.1 Calibrating in isat

3.3.2.5.2 Calibrating on the exponential

3.3.2.5.3 Bayesian calibration

3.3.2.5.4 Calibration using pressure wave

3.3.3 Bdot coils

3.3.3.1 In-shaft circuit

3.3.3.1.1 Why do we have that?

3.3.3.1.2 Where is it placed approximately?

Table 3.5: Chen parameters

3.3.3.2 Circuit model**3.3.3.3 Calibration****3.3.3.3.1 Directional****3.3.3.3.2 Transfer Function****3.4 Plasma Theory****3.4.1 Simple Plasma Theory (Hutchinson)****3.4.1.1 Derivation****3.4.1.2 Pros & Cons****3.4.2 BRL****3.4.2.1 Idea behind it****3.4.2.2 Approximations of it****3.4.2.2.1 Planar probe****3.4.2.2.2 Chen Approximation****3.4.2.2.3 Even more approximation****3.4.3 Effect of electric fields****3.4.3.1 Where does the electric field come from****3.4.3.1.1 Majority inductive**

Figure 3.12: What does an electric field do to the tip measurements diagram.

Figure 3.13: Example plot where E splitting tips

3.4.3.1.2 Some static

3.4.3.1.2.1 What is the expected static magnitude

3.4.3.2 What does it do to the tip measurements

3.4.3.2.1 Theoretical understanding

3.4.3.2.2 Physical reality

Figure 3.14: Diagram of local minimums

3.4.4 Minimum measurable density

3.4.4.1 What's the debye Length

3.4.4.2 Sheath scale

3.4.4.3 Tip-tip sheath overlap

3.5 Curve Fitting

3.5.1 Least squares Fitting

3.5.1.1 Benefits (easy)

3.5.1.2 Issues (not representative of error)

3.5.2 ODR

3.5.2.1 What does error look like in our signals

3.5.2.2 How does ODR take that into account

3.5.2.3 How to apply parameter bounds

3.5.2.3.1 Our method

3.5.2.3.2 Other options

Figure 3.15: Example fit using many shots, multiple local parameter fits, and errors

Figure 3.16: Plot of isat currents from BRL

3.5.3 Monte-carlo Fitting

3.5.3.1 What kind of fits do we get if we just trust a local minimum

3.5.3.2 How do we sample initial conditions

3.5.3.3 More robust methods for getting global minimums

3.5.4 Combining multiple shots

3.5.4.1 Using some time points from each shot

3.5.4.2 Combining all IV points and fitting that

3.5.4.3 Problems

3.5.4.3.1 Timing alignment We'll go into this more in the PA section.

3.5.4.3.2 Variability of plasma parameters

3.6 Results

What is the benefit of doing all this work?

Figure 3.17: Radial chord of initial density with Hutchinson vs BRL.

Figure 3.18: Comparison of expected E from Ohm's law and measured E.

3.6.1 Measurement of low densities

3.6.1.1 How does Hutchinson vs BRL treat ion saturation

3.6.1.2 What are the experimental predictions that Hutchinson vs BRL have

3.6.1.3 How does that change the results

3.6.2 Noise resilience

Not sure how best I should show this.

3.6.3 Fits more accurate

- Each fit uses many data points
- Don't have to arbitrarily cutoff data points

3.6.4 Extracting electric fields

3.6.4.1 Where do we expect electric fields to be

3.6.4.2 Do we see them there

4 PRESSURE ANISOTROPY PROBE

4.1 How can we measure Pressure Anisotropy

4.1.1 Thomson Scattering

4.1.1.1 Pros

4.1.1.2 Cons

- Requires a lot of playing around with optics
- Size of machine
- Don't have much in-lab expertise
- Getting all the photons is tough
- Don't have optics stuff setup

4.1.2 Directional Langmuir Probe

4.1.2.1 Pros

- Simplicity
- Cost
- Mobility

4.1.2.2 Cons

- Difficult to interpret results precisely (luckily only need relative stuff)
- Can't perfectly model
- Requires a lot of playing around with circuits

Figure 4.1: Picture of feed thru along with drawings of cross-sections.

Figure 4.2: Picture of end of probe

Figure 4.3: CAD diagram of full body

4.2 Hardware

4.2.1 Shaft Components

4.2.1.1 Garages

4.2.1.2 Shaft materials

4.2.1.3 Centering Collet

4.2.1.4 Feed-thru

4.2.2 Tip Components

4.2.2.1 Probe body

4.2.2.1.1 3D printed

4.2.2.1.2 Both sides fit together

4.2.2.2 Tip material + size

4.2.2.2.1 Shell material

4.2.2.2.2 Core material

Figure 4.4: CAD diagram of probe tip

Table 4.1: Length scales of probe

Figure 4.5: Simple circuit diagram of how bias works.

4.2.2.3 Tip Shielding

4.2.2.3.1 Shell Shielding

4.2.2.3.2 Core Shielding

4.2.3 Bdot Coils

Same as Te probe

4.2.4 Connecting Bdot - Probe - Shaft

4.2.5 Length Scales

4.3 Circuitry

4.3.1 Bias Source

4.3.1.1 Principles of operation

4.3.1.1.1 Charging

4.3.1.1.2 Discharging

4.3.1.1.3 Swapping polarity

4.3.1.2 How do we do this

4.3.1.2.1 Cannibalization

Figure 4.6: Full circuit diagram of how bias works.

Figure 4.7: Image of power supply setup

4.3.1.2.2 Discharging

4.3.1.2.3 Safety Diodes for discharging the wrong way.

4.3.1.2.4 Cap arcing

4.3.1.2.4.1 What happened

4.3.1.2.4.2 Solution

4.3.1.2.5 Reducing voltage drop due to inductance

4.3.1.2.5.1 Twisting Wires

4.3.1.2.5.2 Adding cap next to board

4.3.1.2.6 Reversing polarity

4.3.1.2.6.1 Why we break relay

4.3.1.2.6.2 How do we fix this problem

4.3.1.2.7 LabView (ew)

4.3.1.2.7.1 Controls CRIO

4.3.1.2.7.2 Countdown if too high of voltage for swapping

Table 4.2: Bias circuit component values

Table 4.3: Probe circuit component values

Figure 4.8: Schematic of grounding diagram

4.3.1.3 Calibration

4.3.1.3.1 Calibrating power supply output

4.3.1.3.2 Calibrating cap bank output

4.3.2 Probe Circuit

4.3.2.1 Single-ended measurement

4.3.2.1.1 TREX cells

4.3.2.1.2 Why was this bad

4.3.2.1.3 How long did we spend on this :(

4.3.2.2 Differential measurement

4.3.2.2.1 Parallel circuitry

4.3.2.3 Figuring out grounds

4.3.2.3.1 Types of grounds on the ACQ

4.3.2.3.2 Routing grounds

Figure 4.9: Image of swapping box

Figure 4.10: Diagram of swapping

Figure 4.11: Time frame for core movie of IV with separation between relay

4.3.2.4 Swapping current paths

4.3.2.4.1 Why do we want to do this

4.3.2.4.1.1 Takes care of small differences in resistors

4.3.2.4.2 Circuitry to do this

4.3.2.4.2.1 Only swap core stuff

4.3.2.4.2.2 Many relays

4.3.2.4.2.3 Remote control

4.3.2.4.3 How does this change results

4.3.2.5 Circuit Solution

4.3.2.5.1 Solution

4.3.2.5.2 Assumptions

4.3.2.6 Calibration

4.3.2.6.1 Calibrating in isat

Figure 4.12: Circuit diagram of probe circuitry

Figure 4.13: Image of probe circuitry

Figure 4.14: Probe signals showing coupling

4.3.2.6.2 Calibrating on the exponential

4.3.2.6.3 Rotation calibration

4.3.2.7 The path to ground

4.3.2.7.1 Why do we have to care

4.3.2.7.2 How do we set it

4.3.2.8 Capacitive coupling

4.3.2.8.1 Where does it come from

4.3.2.8.2 Where do we see it

4.3.2.8.3 Magnitude of effect

4.3.2.8.4 Removing effect

Figure 4.15: Figure of theoretical plasma distributions and JV curves

4.4 Plasma Theory

4.4.1 A full model

4.4.1.1 Plasma Distribution

4.4.1.2 Ion particle flux

4.4.1.2.1 Mach effects

4.4.1.3 Electron particle flux

4.4.1.3.1 Minimum velocity

4.4.1.3.2 Area

4.4.1.3.3 Particle Flux

4.4.1.4 Theoretical JV curves

4.4.1.4.1 Reading radar plots

4.4.1.4.1.1 Radar axis

4.4.1.4.1.2 Solutions

4.4.2 Individual tip fitting

4.4.2.1 Why do this instead

4.4.2.2 Methods

4.4.2.2.1 Aforementioned methods

Figure 4.16: Simple drawing of what might happen to ions

4.4.2.2.2 Exponential

4.4.2.2.2.1 Ions don't hit core

4.4.2.2.2.2 Take care of this by allowing free parameters

4.4.2.2.2.3 Converting from plasma parameters to exponential

4.4.2.2.2.4 Converting back

4.4.2.2.2.5 Taking care of errors

4.4.2.3 Extracting plasma parameters

4.4.2.3.1 Spherical harmonics

4.4.2.3.2 Error bars

4.4.2.3.2.1 Monte-carlo

4.4.2.3.2.2 Other options

4.4.2.3.2.3 Why can we ignore non-bi-maxwellian features

4.5 Curve Fitting

We will use ODR like mentioned in Te section.

Figure 4.17: Comparison of alignment using $B_z = 0$ or $\mathbf{b} \cdot \mathbf{d}$ cross correlation

4.5.1 Combining multiple shots

4.5.1.1 Timing alignment

4.5.1.1.1 $B_z = 0$ alignment

4.5.1.1.1.1 Aligns where we expect Anisotropy

4.5.1.1.1.2 Depends heavily on prior $\mathbf{b} \cdot \mathbf{d}$ data

4.5.1.1.2 $\mathbf{b} \cdot \mathbf{d}$ cross correlation

4.5.1.1.2.1 Still requires smoothing to get rid of initial oscillation impact

4.5.1.1.3 Result comparison

4.5.1.2 Averaging of core data

4.5.1.2.1 Weighted average of relay on/off

4.5.2 Fitting shell

4.5.2.1 Use all shell data

4.5.2.2 Fit using BRL

4.5.2.3 Fits pretty good

4.5.3 Fitting core

4.5.3.1 Fitting using full routine

4.5.3.1.1 Slow

4.5.3.1.2 Model not perfectly representative

4.5.3.2 Fitting tips independently

4.5.3.2.1 Individual fitting method

4.5.3.2.2 Holding Vprobe constant

4.5.3.2.3 Exponential fitting method

4.5.3.2.4 Spherical harmonics

4.6 Results

Figure out what my results are once I have some reasonable results

4.6.1 Drive cylinder

4.6.1.1 What did we try

4.6.1.2 Why didn't we see pressure anisotropy

4.6.1.2.1 In the bdot data

4.6.1.2.2 In the PA data

4.6.2 3 coil

4.6.2.1 How much anisotropy should we expect

4.6.2.2 What setups did we try

4.6.2.3 Old results of just comparing radar plots

4.6.2.4 New results using independent fitting

5 CONCLUSION

5.1 Summary of thesis

- 5.1.1 Using pressure waves to measure density
- 5.1.2 Upgrading langmuir probe analysis and new possibilities
- 5.1.3 Using directional langmuir probes for measuring pressure anisotropy

5.2 Future work

- 5.2.1 Pressure wave
 - 5.2.1.1 Aforementioned future work
 - 5.2.1.2 Extracting cross-field diffusion
- 5.2.2 Langmuir Probe
 - 5.2.2.1 Prepared to analyze lots of cool data
 - 5.2.2.2 Extract out electric field
- 5.2.3 PA Probe
 - 5.2.3.1 Try more configurations
 - 5.2.3.2 Map out full pressure anisotropy during shot

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